Digital menu - responsive website

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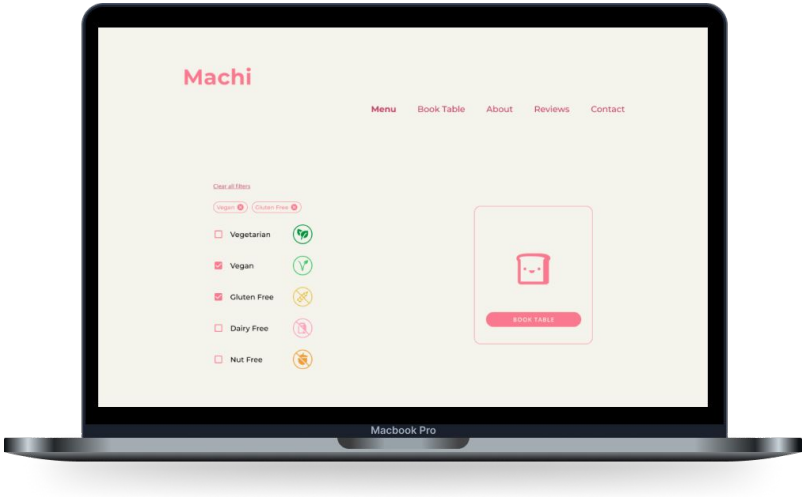
Project overview

The product:

Machi is a restaurant that caters to diverse dietary needs. The goal of this project was to create a responsive website for the restaurant.

Project duration:

October 2021 - November 2021



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Project overview

The problem:

People with dietary requirements don’t know if restaurants can meet them.

The goal:

Create an easy way for users to check if a restaurant meets their dietary needs.

Project overview

My role:

UX designer and researcher designing an app for cinematic from conception to delivery.

Responsibilities:

Conducting interviews, paper and digital wireframing, low and high-fidelity prototyping, conducting usability studies, accounting for accessibility, and iterating on designs.

Understanding the user

- User research
- Personas
- Problem statements
- User journey maps

User research: summary

I conducted interviews and created empathy maps to understand the users I'm designing for and their needs. A primary user group identified through research was young adults with dietary requirements. They often try to search if restaurants meet their needs and experience frustrations associated to this process.

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User research: pain points

1

No Information

Users can’t find if a restaurant offers options that meet their dietary needs.

2

Difficult Access

Information about the restaurants is scattered over second party websites.

3

Bad Communication

Users experience frustrations when trying to book a table through the phone.

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Persona: **Megan**

Problem statement:

Megan is a young adult who needs to find if restaurant's meet their dietary needs because they recently went vegan.

"Because of my dietary requirements, I feel more comfortable knowing beforehand the options available at a restaurant"

Goals

- Find restaurants that meet their dietary preferences
- Getting a quick impression of a restaurant

Frustrations

- The menu being outdated or unclear
- Having a hard time finding the menu
- The menu being blocked by a third party service

Megan

Age: 25
Education: MA Chemical Engineering
Hometown: Hamburg, Germany
Family: Partner and cat
Occupation: Internship

Megan is a 25 year old, recently graduated chemical engineer, who is now an intern at the sustainability team for a healthcare company. They are working full time and enjoy trying new restaurants on the weekend with friends.

They are lactose intolerant and recently went vegan because of environmental concerns. They can be anxious to try new places because of their dietary restrictions and frustrated when the menu is difficult to find or doesn't offer clear information on dietary requirements.

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User journey map

Persona: Megan

Goal: Check if restaurants meet their dietary requirements

ACTION	Remember a restaurant recommended by a friend	Search for the menu on their phone	Read the menu
TASK LIST	Tasks A. Remember friend recommendation B. Open messages C. Look for the name of the restaurant	Tasks A. Copy the name B. Search for the menu on the phone	Tasks A. Look for a vegan section B. Look at the dish descriptions
FEELING ADJECTIVE	Excited about the new restaurant Anxious if they will offer vegan options	Confused about where to find the menu	Frustrated by lack of information on dietary requirements Sad about the limited offering
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	Area to improve	Restaurant offering the menu on their website	Use of icons to signal dietary requirements Dedicated sections

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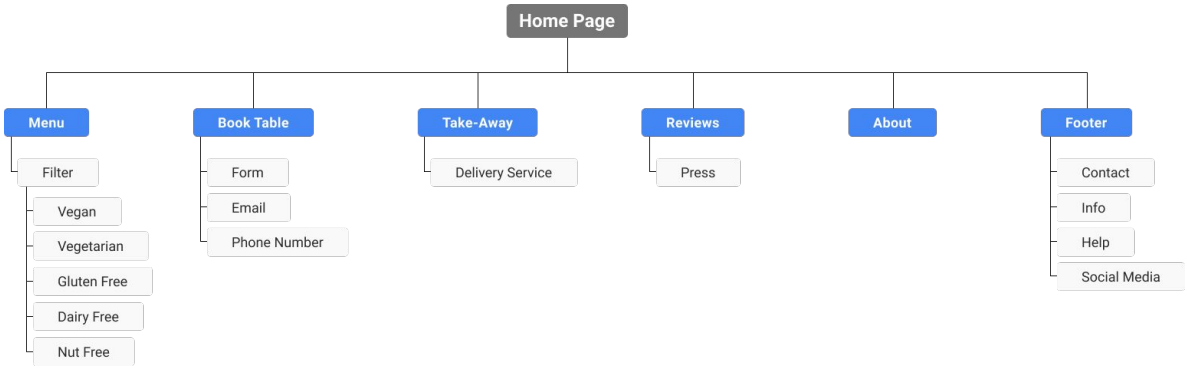
Starting the design

- Sitemap
- Paper wireframes
- Digital wireframes
- Low-fidelity prototype
- Usability studies

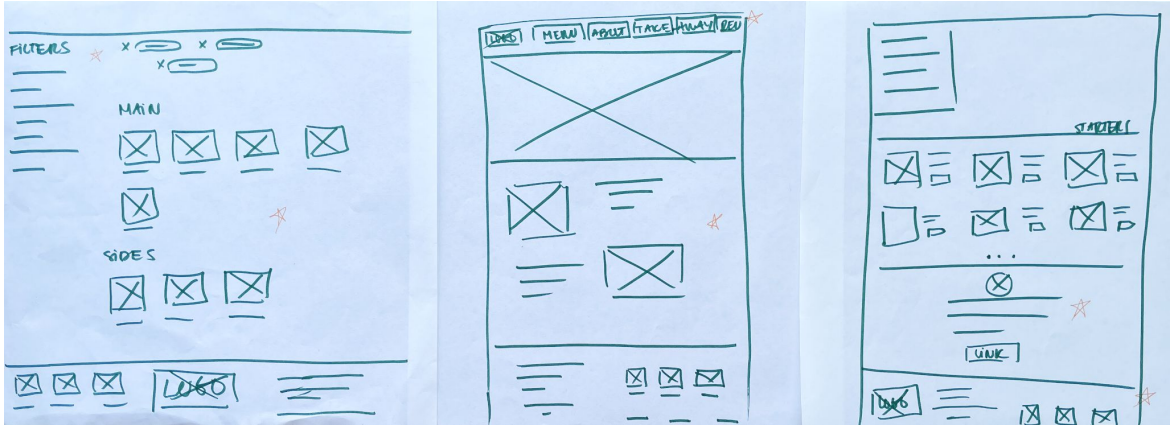
Sitemap

I created a sitemap that mapped what users might want to do on the website, from checking what the restaurant had to offer to booking a table.



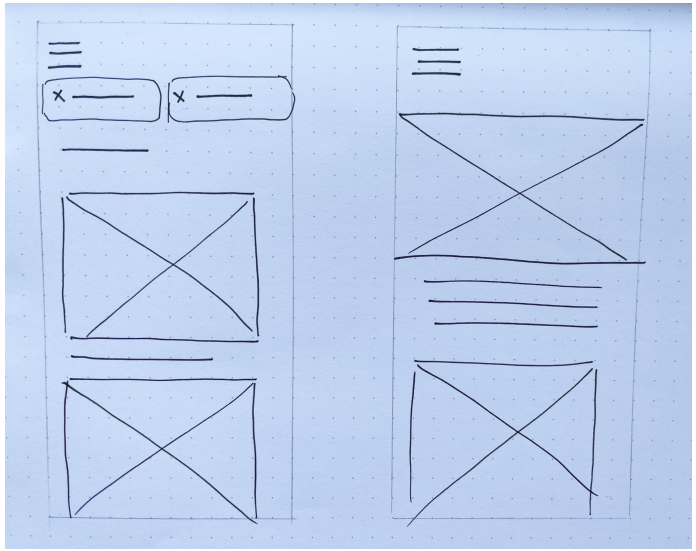
Paper wireframes

I explored iterations of each screen of the app on paper to ensured that the final elements on the digital wireframes would truly address user pain points. For the home page, I prioritized a **quick and easy way** for users to filter the menu according to their preferences.



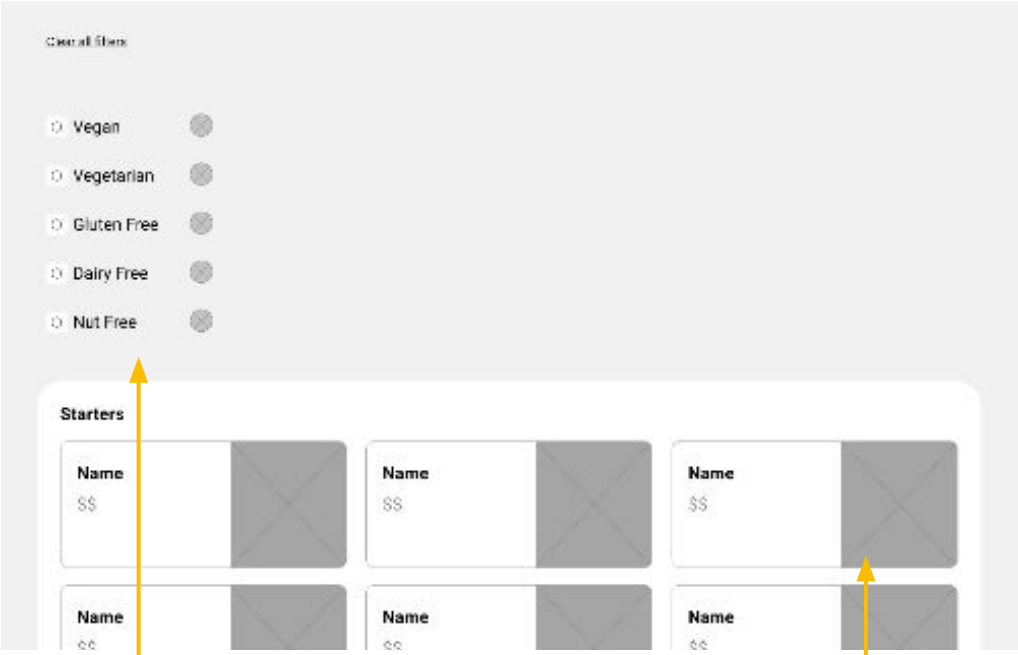
Paper wireframe screen size variation

I explored how the designs would fit in the mobile version. To adapt to the smaller screen size, I used a hamburger menu to hide the navigation, side scrolling filters and a single column layout.



Digital wireframes

As the ideation phase continued, I made sure to use feedback and findings from the user research to inform my designs.



The filters help users search by dietary requirements

Cards provide additional information

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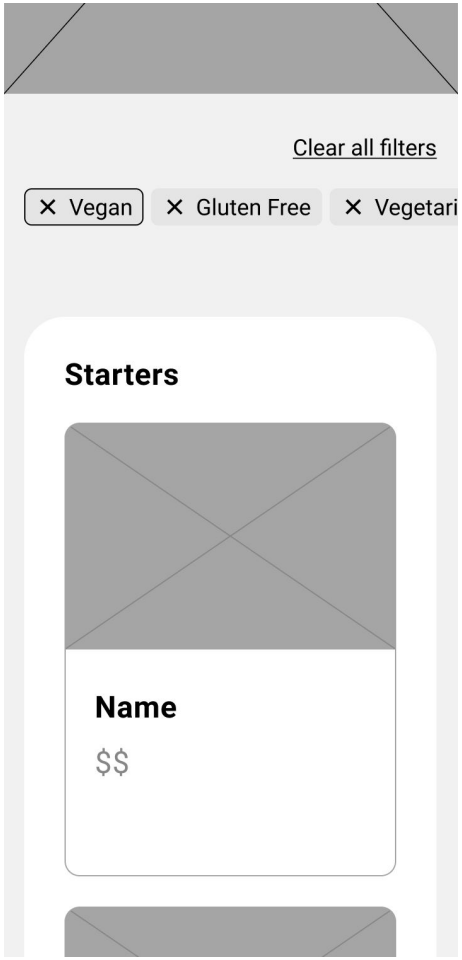
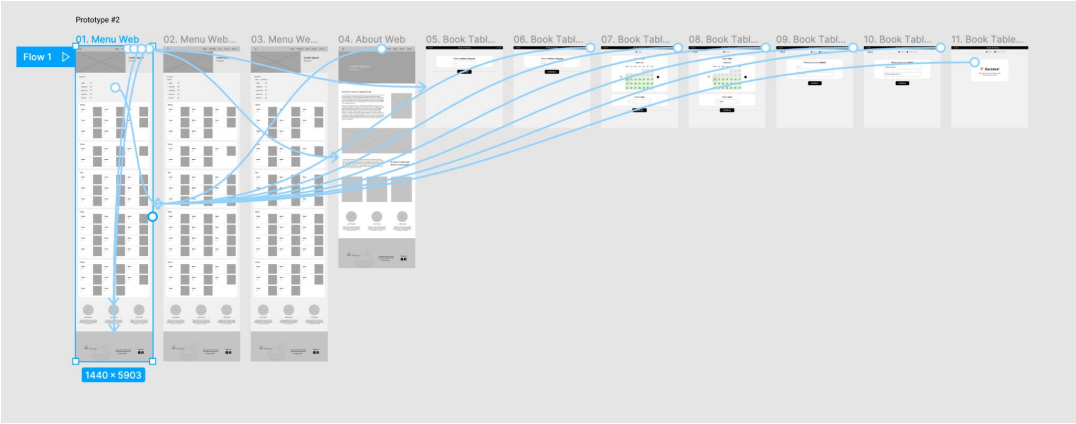
Digital wireframe screen size variation

I adapted the design to better fit the mobile screen size with side scrolling filters and a single column layout.



Low-fidelity prototype

I created a low-fidelity prototype with the complete set of digital wireframes. The primary user flows I wanted to test in a usability study were filtering the menu and booking a table



View the

[low-fidelity prototype]

Usability study: parameters

Study type:

Moderated usability study

Location:

Lisbon, Portugal

Participants:

5 participants

Length:

20-30 minutes

Usability study: findings

Insert a one to two sentence introduction to the findings shared below.

1

Finding

Users found the filters intuitive to use.

2

Finding

Users need feedback from the booking system.

3

Finding

Users want a consistent navigation.

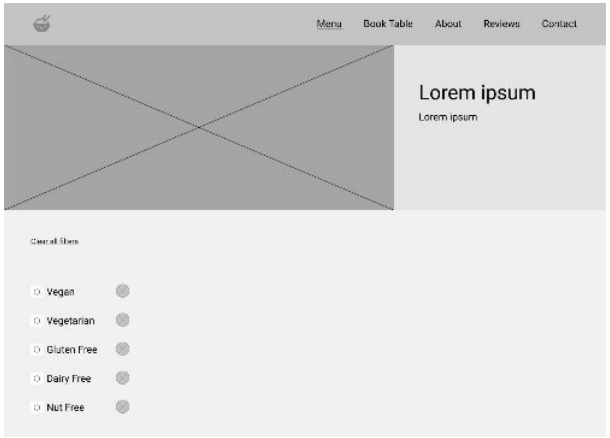
Refining the design

- Mockups
- High-fidelity prototype
- Accessibility

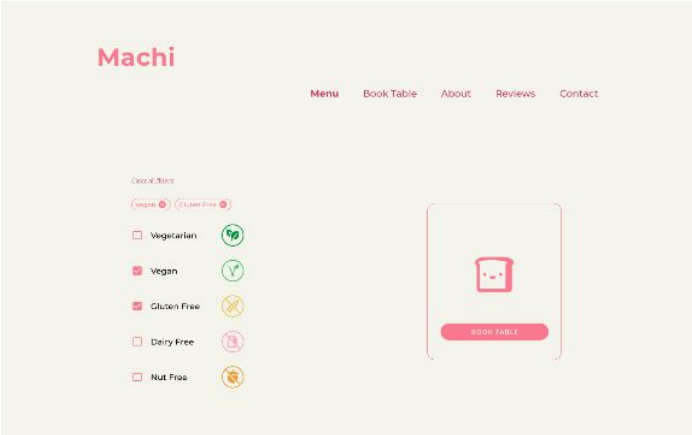
Mockups

I turned the wireframes into high fidelity mockups by implementing the filters feature and making the navigation more consistent across the pages.

Before usability study

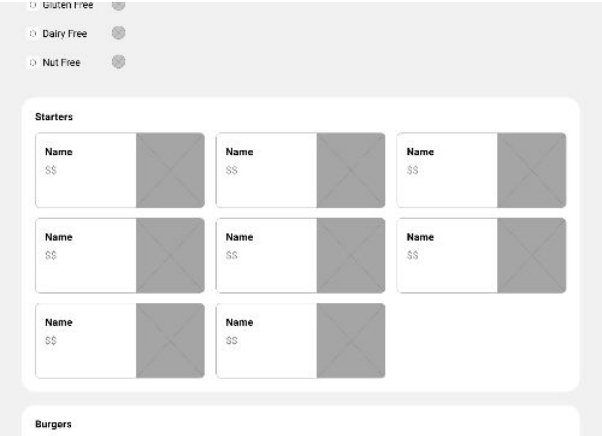


After usability study

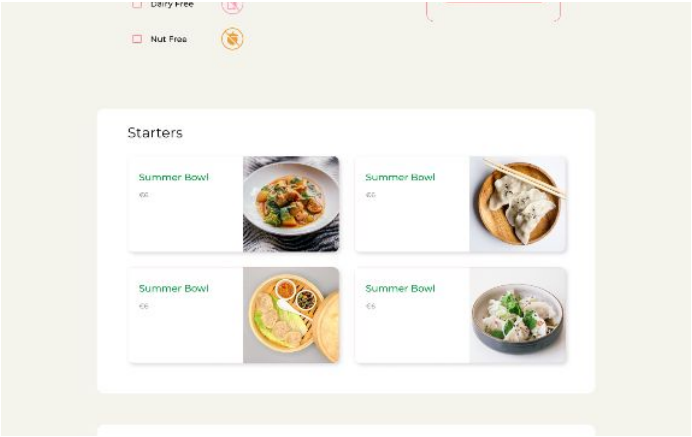


Mockups

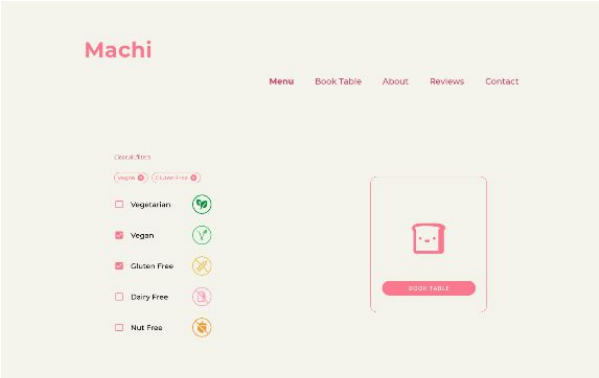
Before usability study

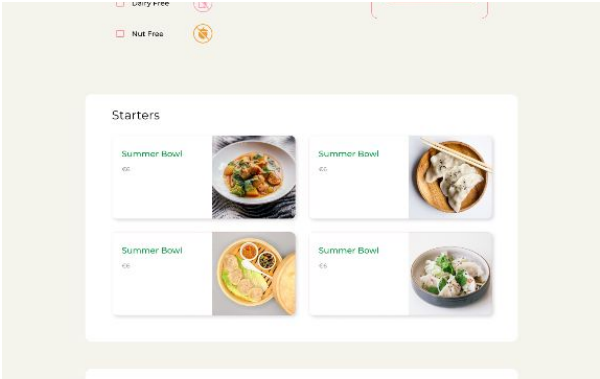


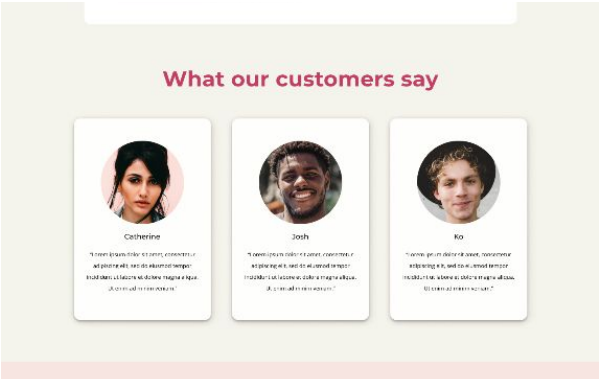
After usability study



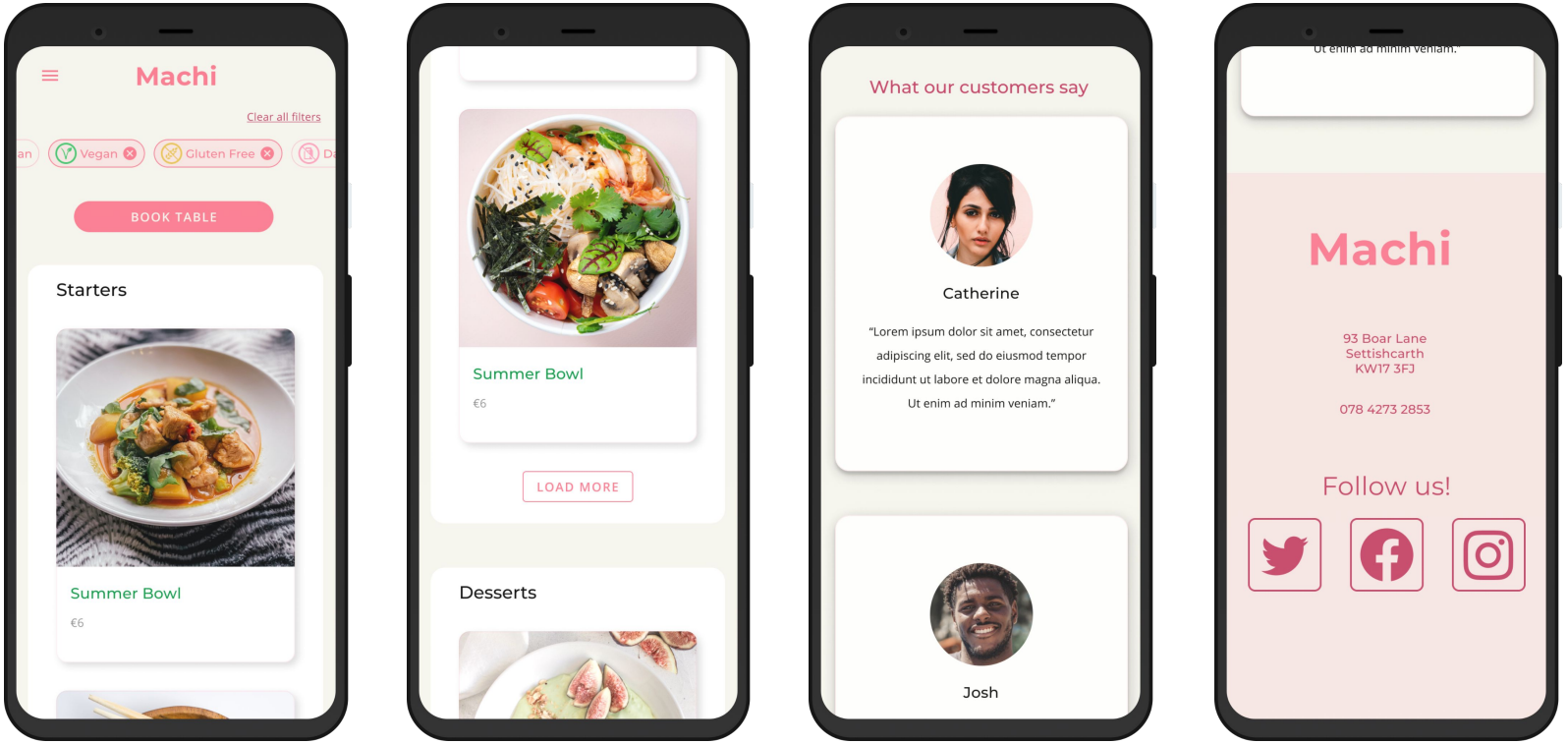
Mockups: Original screen size







Mockups: Screen size variations



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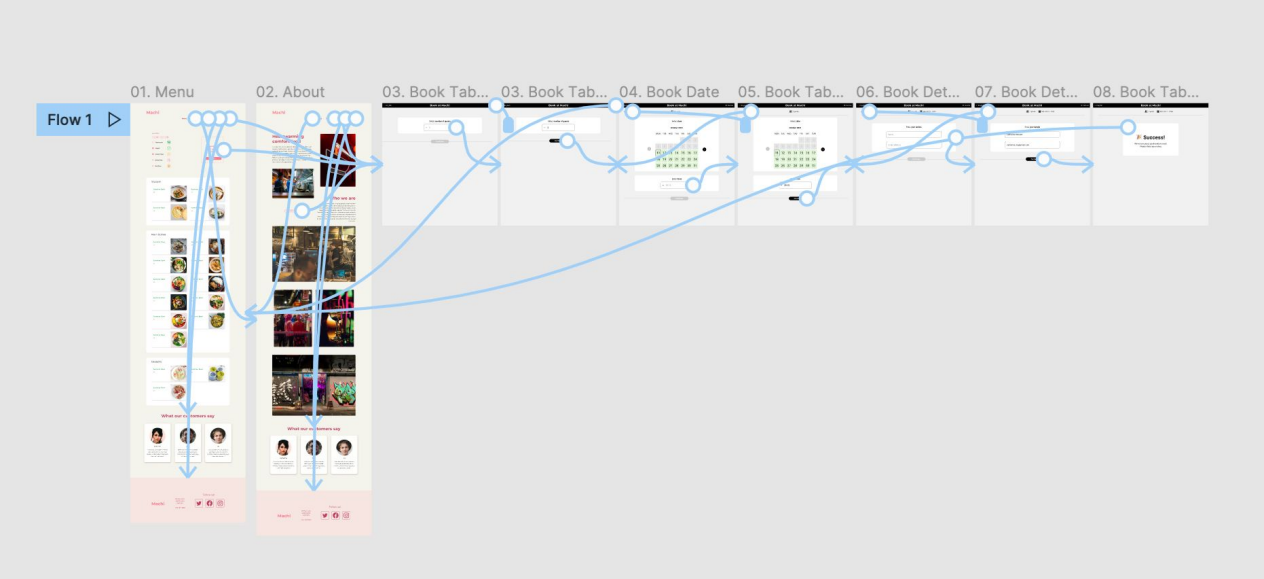
High-fidelity prototype

The final high-fidelity prototype polished the user flow and provided users with better feedback along the way.

View the [high-fidelity prototype]



Accessibility considerations

1

Added alt text to images for screen readers to support users with impaired vision.

2

Used icons to make navigation easier.

3

Opted for easy to access navigation that's screen reader friendly.

Going forward

- Takeaways
- Next steps

Takeaways

Impact:

Users feel like the website is easy to use and meets their needs by providing proper feedback and useful information.

One quote from peer feedback:

"The filtering feature was easy to use and I would definitely use it when browsing for restaurants!"

What I learned:

While designing the responsive website, I learned how important it is to consider different screen sizes and the situations users might be in while using the product.

Next steps

1

Validate whether the pain points users experienced have been effectively addressed with another round of usability studies.

2

Conduct more research to determine other user needs.

3

Investigate the impact of the filtering feature after launch.

Let’s connect!

Thank you for your time reviewing my work on the responsive website for the restaurant Machi! If you’d like to
see more or get in touch, my contact information is provided below.

Website: yokochi.design

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